

The centrally-placed multi-information display panel shows the standard tripmeter, odometer, alerts and notifications, but somehow doesn't let you access call lists and recently played tracks, like in the Verna and Elantra. The panel is also monochrome, which may make it seem a bit dull on overall terms.

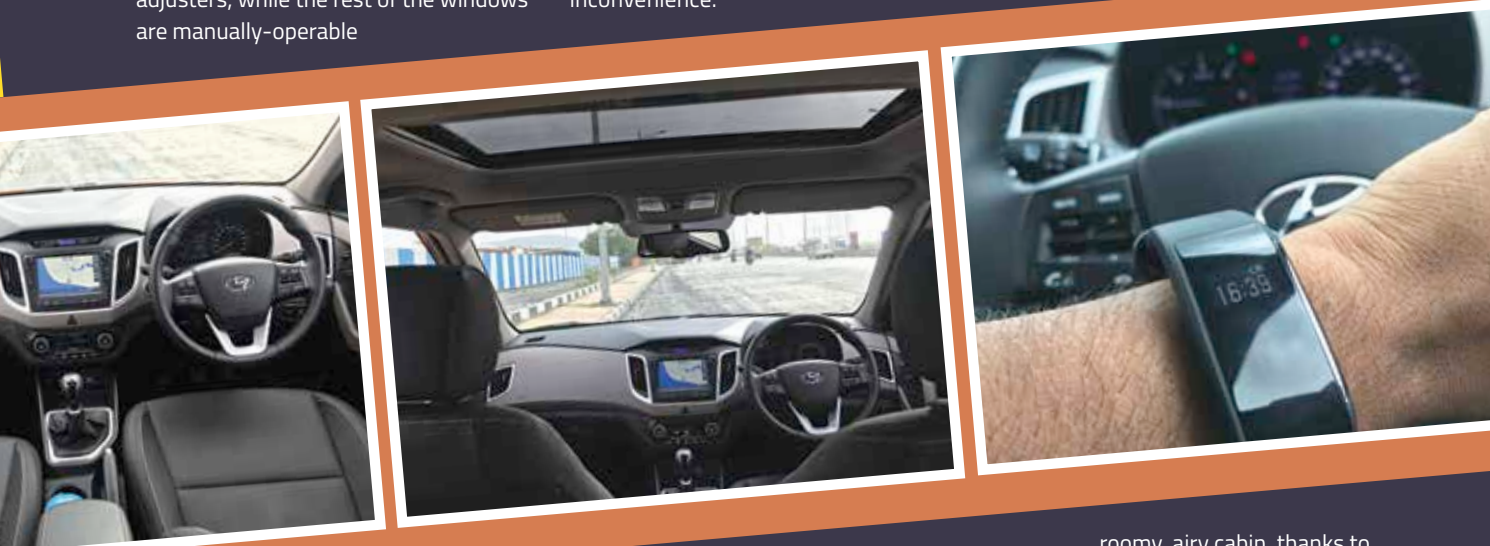
The Creta includes two USB ports, an SD card slot (which houses the navigation maps), an aux port and Bluetooth as well as wireless charging. It doesn't get the cooled seats like the Verna and Elantra, but the ORVMs are auto-folding. There are no automatic headlamps either. The driver's seat gets six-way electronic seat adjusters and an auto-winding window, while the front passenger seat has manual adjusters, while the rest of the windows are manually-operable

of functions that you can carry out with the Hyundai H-Band include locking/unlocking, tailgate opening, engine start/stop, time display, vibration-based alarm and call alert, and in combination with a smartphone app called H-Band (available on Android and iOS), even record sleep cycles, show total/average calories burnt, steps taken and distance travelled.

While the Hyundai H-Band doesn't look particularly impressive, it is functional, and I actually left behind my wristwatch out of sheer convenience. That said, it still needs improving in terms of overall quality of build and reliability of showing time. After one full week, the H-Band still had 25 percent charge left, so battery life and frequent charging should be of no great inconvenience.

have a likewise impact on the overall design – nothing too remarkable, but definitely an aesthetic impact that makes the Creta more of an SUV. On the inside, the overall layout of the dash is the same as the pre-facelift version. The notable upgrades here include a cruise control button on the steering wheel, electrically-adjustable driver's seat, a small dustbin with a blue cap on top, and the sunroof.

The entire layout, including that of all the controls and the central touchscreen are ergonomic, and we didn't really have much to complain about. The overall quality of plastics is decent, albeit a bit hard and scratchy in certain places. What we really like about the Creta is its



electronic ones. This new Creta also gets a sunroof, an increasingly popular choice even though India is not the strictly ideal country for top-down summertime cruising.

Talking of cruising, the 2018 Hyundai Creta now has cruise control, which coupled with the sunroof, the Arkamys sound mode and fairly impressive noise refinement, makes it a very enjoyable highway cruiser. Features like the auto-dimming day/night IRVM make it an easier car to live with. The pick of the pack, though, is the Hyundai H-Band. A smart band very similar to the prototype that Tata showed with the Nexon, it is essentially a replacement for the key fob. It looks almost identical to the Fitbit Charge lineup of smart fitness bands, and charges via the provided proprietary adapter. The range

DESIGN: INTERIORS AND EXTERIORS

There's literally no difference on the side profile – the silhouette is exactly as the previous Creta. That, though, is a good thing, since the Creta already had a very proportionate design. The more chrome-infused front grille now looks bolder and more refined, and has been made bigger to give the car a more imposing nose. The slightly larger wheels with new, diamond-cut alloys look smart and suave, but aren't particularly groundbreaking.

The new front grille looks impressive, but you will need to look closely to notice the change. It is bigger, broader and has better presence, making the Creta look more 'SUV-like'. The alterations to the front and rear bumpers, too,

roomy, airy cabin, thanks to the large windows and now the sunroof. The all-black interiors in combination with the grey accents, however, do make things look slightly dull. The overall design and layout is also quite smart, and to sum it up, the 2018 Hyundai Creta largely continues with the same design, quality and ergonomics as the one before, while making small additions. These small additions may not spell magic, but they do refine the car by a margin. I personally feel that Hyundai could have done much more with the Creta, and this facelift feels a bit too similar to the outgoing one. This works against the Creta, but only when you compare it with the older one. Evaluate it on standalone terms, and the 2018 Hyundai Creta has all the bells and whistles that you would want, need and expect from a car of its stature. **d**